

MERIDIAN HEALTH PLAN

Medical Policy: Advanced Imaging - MRI Brain without Contrast

Policy Number: POL-MRI-70551

Procedure: MRI brain without contrast (CPT 70551)

PRIOR AUTHORIZATION REQUIRED: Yes

Coverage Criteria. Prior authorization for MRI of the brain without contrast (CPT 70551) will be approved when ALL of the following criteria are met:

1. Documented new or progressive neurological symptoms persisting for at least 4 weeks (for example, persistent headache with red-flag features, focal weakness, or new-onset seizure).
2. Completion of an appropriate initial clinical evaluation, including a documented neurological examination.
3. Absence of a recent equivalent brain MRI within the prior 6 months, unless there is a documented clinical change warranting repeat imaging.

Requests that do not meet these criteria will be routed for manual clinical review.